

ART & CULTURE



INDIAN ARCHITECTURE

MODULE - 5

ART AND ARCHITECTURE OF HARAPPAN PERIOD (PART-3)

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

SOCIETY AND GOVERNMENT



***Standardized bricks used in
Harappan culture***

- 1 From the archeological findings, it is noted that the **Harappan bricks, seal weights are etched uniformly** irrespective of not being produced in the same center and being found in different places.
- 2 The uniformity in bricks is especially noteworthy as they had common ratio of length, breadth and height.
- 3 Further the **existence of town planning, establishment of settlements near the source of raw materials** all point towards existence of some kind of central authority.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

SOCIETY AND GOVERNMENT



Cubical weights made of cherts

4 Some historians even suggest that each of the various sites could have had separate rulers.

5 However, the latter is less likely considering the uniformity in weights and measures, bricks and artifacts.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

BURIALS AND BELIEF IN AFTER LIFE



- 1** At some of the Harappan sites, burial chambers have been discovered which are generally in the form of pits.
- 2** In some burial pits, brick linings were also found indicating existence of social differences.
- 3** Some of the dead were buried along with items of jewellery, pottery indicating belief in after life.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

BURIALS AND BELIEF IN AFTER LIFE



Burial pits and pottery buried along with the dead indicates their belief of after-life

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

TRADE AND COMMERCE



- 1 Trade and commerce was an important sector of this culture's economy as is evident from the numerous seals and artifacts.
- 2 The raw materials used in production were sourced from different places like copper from Oman- as chemical analysis shows Omani copper and Harappan artifacts seems to have traces of nickel which indicates common origin.
- 3 Similarly Harappan artifacts have been found at different sites too like Harappan jars found at Omani sites.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

TRADE AND COMMERCE

4 The trade and Commerce could have been carried through land or through sea.

5 Seals depicting ships have been discovered besides dockyard of Lothal, which is further indicative of sea trade.



Boat-shaped seal found in Lothal

OTHER IMPORTANT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

1

FABRIC AND CLOTH



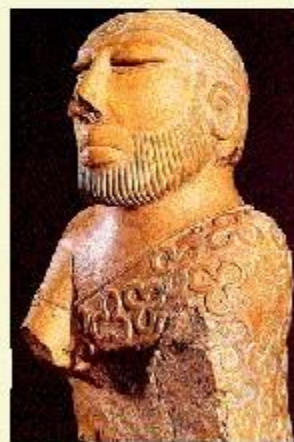
- 1 Cotton was commonly used as fabric for clothing, although wool could have also been used.
- 2 Findings of spindles indicating that weaving and spinning was known.
- 3 Needles and buttons have been discovered indicating that perhaps stitching was also known.

OTHER IMPORTANT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

1

FABRIC AND CLOTH

- 4 Dress or fabric has not survived, but statues and figurines suggest two pieces of clothes were used by men and women, one piece resembled dhoti covering lower body and the other portion was worn over the left shoulder under the right arm.



Recreation of clothing from male figurine

OTHER IMPORTANT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

2

GAMES AND SPORTS

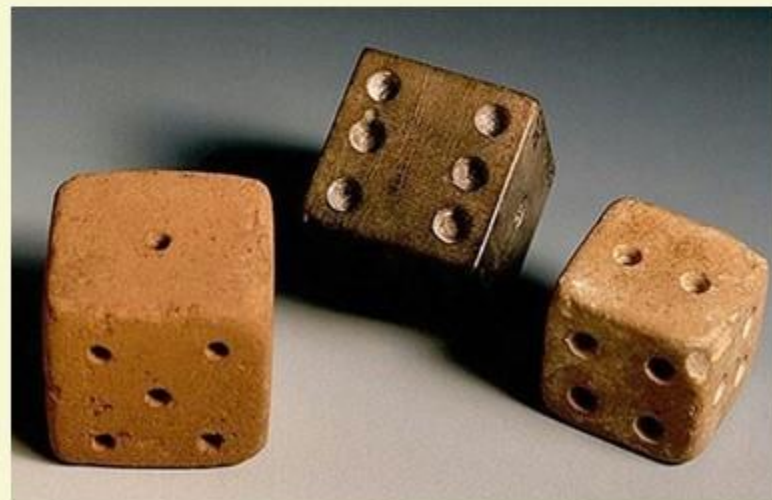
1

Objects similar to **dice games** and **play cards** have been found. **Hunting** is believed to be common as seen from a number of seals carrying images of animals.



2

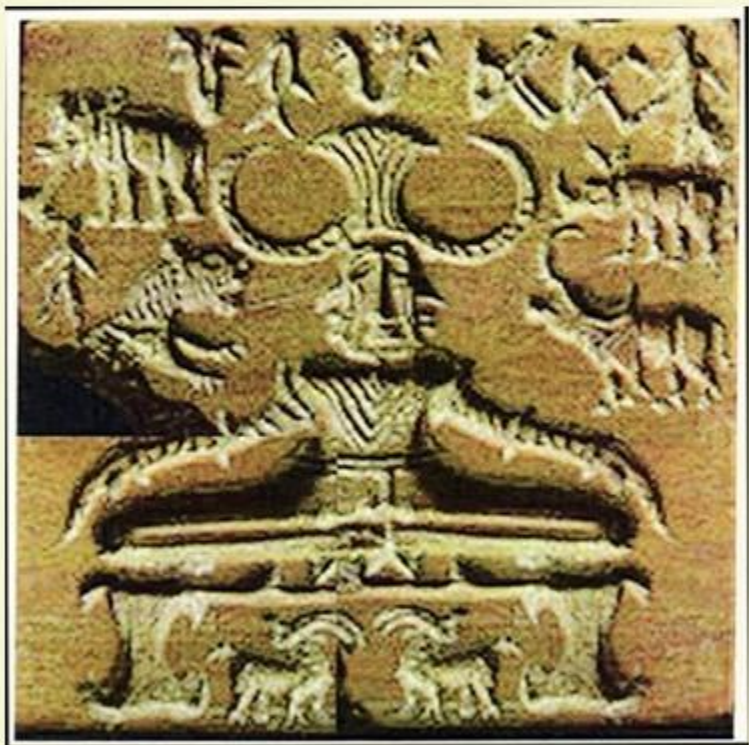
Dancing and singing were popular as seen from bronze statue of the Dancing Girl.



OTHER IMPORTANT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

3

RELIGION



1 Discovering the seal of Pashupati (Proto-Shiva) and figurines believed to be of mother goddess indicate the presence of religious beliefs comparable to early Hinduism.

2 However, historians believed that the religion does not seem to have a predominant influence on the society.

OTHER IMPORTANT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

4

AGRICULTURE



- 1 Discovery of grains at some of the Harappan sites and terracotta models of plough found at Cholistan and Banawali point towards prevalence of agriculture.
- 2 Terracotta figurines, statues and seals of bulls also suggest that oxen might have been used for ploughing.
- 3 Evidence of ploughed fields have been found at Kalibangan. Irrigation is thought to have been carried by the use of wells or reservoirs which were found at Dholavira. Barley and Wheat were the major cultivated cereal crops.

IMPORTANT HARAPPAN SITES AND THEIR SIGNIFICANCE

S.No	SITES AND PRESENT LOCATION	SIGNIFICANCE AND ARCHAEOLOGICAL DISCOVERIES
1	Mohenjo daro - In Pakistan	▪ One of the better preserved sites
		▪ Discovery of great bath , granary, post cremation burial.
		▪ Sewage system, Sculpture of bearded priest .
2	Harappa - In Pakistan	▪ Two rows of 6 granaries with big platform
		▪ Mother goddess figure, stone symbol of lingam and yoni
		▪ Sculpture of dog chasing a deer in bronze metal, red sand stone male torso statue.
		▪ Wheat and Barley in wooden mortar
		▪ Dyes and mirror



PAKISTAN

INDIA

ARABIAN SEA

Harappa

Mohenjodaro

Kot Diji

Dholavira

Lothal

Kalibangan

Rakhigarhi

Banawali

Ropar

Bhiranna

IMPORTANT HARAPPAN SITES AND THEIR SIGNIFICANCE

S.No	SITES AND PRESENT LOCATION	SIGNIFICANCE AND ARCHAEOLOGICAL DISCOVERIES
3	Lothal – In Gujarat	▪ Manchester of Indus valley civilization
		▪ Existence of dockyard
		▪ Discovery of weights and measures (instrument for measuring 45,90&180 degree angles)
		▪ Flourishing center of beads and gem making
4	Dholavira – In Gujarat	▪ Discovery of large water reservoirs built of stone, drawing water from channels and rivers
		▪ Unique water harnessing system , dams and embankments
		▪ Inscription containing 10 large sized signed signs like an advertising board.



PAKISTAN

INDIA

ARABIAN SEA

Harappa

Mohenjodaro

Kot Diji

Kalibangan

Dholavira

Lothal

Ropar

Banawali

Rakhigarhi

Bhiranna

IMPORTANT HARAPPAN SITES AND THEIR SIGNIFICANCE

S.No	SITES AND PRESENT LOCATION	SIGNIFICANCE AND ARCHAEOLOGICAL DISCOVERIES
5	Rakhigarhi - In Haryana	▪ Important and a very large site
		▪ Discovery of artifacts 5,000 years old (early Harappan phase)
		▪ Discovery of female skeleton with shells bangles and gold armlet
		▪ Paved roads, rain water collection, drainage system, granary, bangles etc.
6	Kalibangan & Balathal - In Rajasthan	▪ Kalibangan literally means black bangles owing to the discovery of a number of terracotta black bangles at the site.
		▪ Fortified settlement, citadel and fire altars discovered
		▪ Toy carts , bones of Camels, decorated bricks.

IMPORTANT HARAPPAN SITES AND THEIR SIGNIFICANCE

S.No	SITES AND PRESENT LOCATION	SIGNIFICANCE AND ARCHAEOLOGICAL DISCOVERIES
7	Kot Diji - In Pakistan	▪ Settlement of early Harappan phase, existence of citadel and lower town, discovery of defensive wall.
8	Ropar – In Punjab	▪ Dog buried with human oval pit burials.
9	Banawali – In Haryana	▪ Toy plough, Barley grains , oval shaped settlement
		▪ Only city with radial street.



PAKISTAN

INDIA

ARABIAN SEA

Harappa

Mohenjodaro

Kot Diji

Kalibangan

Dholavira

Lothal

Ropar

Banawali

Rakhigarhi

Bhiranna

END OF HARAPPAN CULTURE

- 1 The mature Harappan culture, broadly speaking, existed between 2500 BC & 1900 BC.



Private Wells

- 2 The whole system of Harappan culture seems to have **uniformity and continuity**.
- 3 Certain elements of Harappan culture distinguish it from the contemporary cultures in Western Asia.
- 4 It planned its towns with **chessboard like system, streets, drainage pipes and waste pits**. On the other hand, the Mesopotamian cities show **a haphazard growth**.
- 5 Rectangular houses with brick-lined bathrooms and wells together with their stairways are found in all Harappan cities.

END OF HARAPPAN CULTURE



6 Such town planning is not to be found in the cities of Western Asia.

7 No other people had built such an excellent drainage system. Also the usage of burnt bricks where not known in other contemporary cultures.

8 The Harappans produced their own characteristics pottery and seals.

9 Above all, they invented their own typical script which bears no resemblance to the Egyptian and Mesopotamian scripts.

10 Although the Harappan culture was Bronze Age culture they used Bronze on a limited scale.

END OF HARAPPAN CULTURE



- 11** Finally, no contemporary cultures spread over such a wide area as the Harappan culture did.
- 12** The structures of Harappa cover 5 km in circuit, and in that way it is one of the largest of its type in the Bronze Age.
- 13** No urban complex of the Harappan magnitude has been discovered so far.

END OF HARAPPAN CULTURE



Floods might have lead to the end of the Harappan culture

- 14** It is as difficult to explain the origin of Harappan culture as its end.
- 15** Various causes have been suggested for the disappearance of the Harappan culture.
- 16** It is said that the amount of rainfall in the Indus region slightly increased around 3000 B.C. and then decreased in the earlier part of the 2000 B.C.
- 17** This may have adversely affected agriculture and stockbreeding.
- 18** Some historians say the decline of the Harappan culture is because of this decrease in fertility of the soil.

END OF HARAPPAN CULTURE



- 19 Others attribute it to a sudden subsidence or upliftment of the land which caused floods.
- 20 Earthquakes caused changes in the course of the Indus which led to the inundation of the hinterland of Mohenjadarro.
- 21 And, still others point out that the Harappan culture was destroyed by the Aryans, but there is very little evidence for this.
- 22 The consequences of disintegration of the largest Bronze Age culture entity are still to be clarified.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao
K. Srikanth
D. Sunil Kumar
L. V. Krishna
Y. Deepthi

Amrita Naidu
M. Binukrishna
G. Ravi Babu
D. Joji
K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 -2 4 4 4 4 7 2
0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9